

Table 1

	DirSync Pro	FreeFileSync	Duplicati
Current version	1.48	6.3	1.3.4
Type	File and folder synchronisation	File and folder synchronisation	Backup client
OS supported	Windows, Mac and Linux	Windows, Mac and Linux	Windows, Mac and Linux
Types of backups supported	Synchronisation, Mirror, Incremental and Contribute	Two way synchronisation, Mirror and Update	Full backup and incremental
Backup storage options	File-based	File-based	File- and cloud-based
Schedule engine	Yes	No	Yes
Backup security	Nil	Nil	Password protection and encryption
File comparison	No	Yes (based on file size, type or content)	No
Filters	Pre-defined (file type, size, date, path and attributes)	Pre-defined (file path and type)	Regular expression-based

Step 1: Open the tool by navigating to *Start > All*

Programs > FreeFileSync

Step 2: In the console, click on the icon of the green gear, select *Mirror* and click *OK*. Leave the other options intact.

Step 3: On the left *Drag & Drop* window, click the *Browse* button and navigate to the directory to be backed up. In the right *Drag & Drop* window, click the *Browse* button and navigate to the directory where the backup is to be stored. It can be a different partition, a USB drive or a network location.

Step 4: Click on *Synchronize Mirror-->* (located on the top right corner of the console) and then on *Start* in the next window.

Step 5: Once the backup is finished, navigate to *Program > Save* to save the current settings.

Ongoing backups

An ongoing backup can be taken by slightly modifying the settings saved earlier.

Step 1: Navigate to *Program > Open* and select the settings file (*SyncSettings_ffs_gui*) saved in the previous section.

Step 2: Click the green gear icon, select *Update-->* and press *OK*.

Follow Steps 4 and 5 as mentioned earlier.

No scheduler

Unfortunately, FreeFileSync doesn't come with a schedule engine but it does support creating a batch file of the tasks, which can then be executed using any of the task planner tools.

Add the tasks using the + icon located in the left *Drag & Drop* window and save them as a batch file using *Program > Save* as the batch job option. This batch file can then be used with any third party task planner tool to schedule the backup.

Restore

To do a full restore, swap the links in the *Drag & Drop* window using the *Swap sides* button for each of the tasks. Change the



Figure 5: FreeFileSync console

Synchronisation settings to Mirror--> using the green gear button and follow Steps 4 and 5 as mentioned above. Though FreeFileSync comes with a limited feature set, it does the job of data backups just fine. Additional resources on FreeFileSync can be found at <http://freefilesync.sourceforge.net/>.

Comparing the tools

Table 1 briefly compares the three tools.

We cannot afford to lose our data. It should be well protected. This article is sufficient to get you started but if you just leave it at that, no purpose is served. Backing up data is a continuous process and not a one-time task. Doing it on a regular basis will maintain data in its most up-to-date form, and save you from the nightmare of data loss. **END** 

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